

Onyx — ImageKit reference

Onyx · multi-process OS on Raspberry Pi 4

The reference of **ImageKit** (`SD:/Lib/imagekit.so`, `user/Kits/imagekit`): what it is for, how a program uses it, and every operation it exposes. The operations' part is made from the kit's headers by `tools/docgen/kitdocs.py` — the headers are the source. Overview of all the kits: [The Kits](#).

Contents

1. What it is
2. Using it
3. Index
4. `imagekit/imagekit.h`

What it is

ImageKit is the system's one picture codec: BMP, GIF, PNG, JPEG, PCX and WebP read; PNG, JPEG, BMP and GIF written; resizing, turning, the photo adjustments.

Include	<code>#include "imagekit/imagekit.h"</code>
Link	<code>lib/imagekit.imp.a</code>
Library	<code>SD:/lib/imagekit.so</code> — 46 entries in its table (<code>user/Kits/imagekit/imagekit.abi</code> , append-only)
Sources	<code>user/Kits/imagekit/</code>

Using it

ImageKit is the system's one picture codec: BMP, GIF, PNG, JPEG, PCX and WebP read; PNG, JPEG, BMP and GIF written.

A picture read, turned, saved in another format:

```
#include "imagekit/imagekit.h"

ik_image *im = ik_load ("SD:/photos/cat.jpg", 0);
if (im)
{
    int w = ik_width (im), h = ik_height (im);
    unsigned *px = ik_pixels (im);           // w * h pixels, 0xAARRGGBB
    ik_rotate (im, 1);                       // a quarter turn clockwise
    ik_save (im, "SD:/photos/cat.png", 90);   // the format: the extension's
    ik_image_free (im);
}
```

Pixels of the program's own, saved:

```
ik_image *shot = ik_image_from (pixels, width, height, width);
ik_save (shot, "SD:/screenshots/shot.png", 0);
ik_image_free (shot);
```

The formats, asked — a file chooser's filter follows what the library knows:

```
struct ik_format f[16];
int n = ik_formats (f, 16);
```

Resizing (`ik_scale`), flipping (`ik_flip`), the photo adjustments and the EXIF orientation are in the same header.

Index

Everything the headers declare, in their order — the details are in each header's part below.

Name	What it does	Header
<code>ik_free</code>	a buffer the library returned	<code>imagekit.h</code>
<code>ik_image_new</code>	transparent black; 0: no memory, a bad size	<code>imagekit.h</code>
<code>ik_image_from</code>	a copy of pixels (stride: in pixels)	<code>imagekit.h</code>
<code>ik_image_copy</code>		<code>imagekit.h</code>
<code>ik_image_free</code>		<code>imagekit.h</code>
<code>ik_width</code>		<code>imagekit.h</code>
<code>ik_height</code>		<code>imagekit.h</code>
<code>ik_format</code>	IK_ARGB8	<code>imagekit.h</code>
<code>ik_pixels</code>	its w * h pixels (until the image changes size)	<code>imagekit.h</code>
<code>ik_fill</code>		<code>imagekit.h</code>
<code>ik_opaque</code>	every pixel's alpha 255	<code>imagekit.h</code>
<code>ik_flatten</code>	laid on a colour, the result opaque	<code>imagekit.h</code>
<code>ik_has_alpha</code>	1: a pixel is not opaque	<code>imagekit.h</code>
<code>ik_formats</code>	how many there are (out: up to max)	<code>imagekit.h</code>
<code>ik_info</code>	(a type)	<code>imagekit.h</code>
<code>ik_is_image_name</code>	by its extension (bmp gif png jpg jpeg jpe pcx webp)	<code>imagekit.h</code>
<code>ik_probe</code>	1 / 0: not a picture this reads	<code>imagekit.h</code>
<code>ik_load</code>	the picture (an animation: its first frame); 0	<code>imagekit.h</code>

Name	What it does	Header
<code>ik_load_mem</code>		<code>imagekit.h</code>
<code>ik_load_preview</code>	the camera's preview, turned as seen; 0: none	<code>imagekit.h</code>
<code>ik_load_format</code>	the last picture read: "PNG", "JPEG"... ("": none)	<code>imagekit.h</code>
<code>ik_frames_load</code>		<code>imagekit.h</code>
<code>ik_frames_load_mem</code>		<code>imagekit.h</code>
<code>ik_frames_count</code>		<code>imagekit.h</code>
<code>ik_frames_pixels</code>	frame i: w * h pixels (the library's)	<code>imagekit.h</code>
<code>ik_frames_delay</code>	how long it shows, ms (0: a still picture)	<code>imagekit.h</code>
<code>ik_frames_width</code>		<code>imagekit.h</code>
<code>ik_frames_height</code>		<code>imagekit.h</code>
<code>ik_frames_free</code>		<code>imagekit.h</code>
<code>ik_frames_take</code>	The frames handed over to the caller (px[i]	<code>imagekit.h</code>
<code>ik_inflate</code>	A deflate stream inflated (zlib	<code>imagekit.h</code>
<code>ik_encode</code>	0 / -1	<code>imagekit.h</code>
<code>ik_save</code>	the format from the path's extension -> 0 / -1	<code>imagekit.h</code>
<code>ik_encode_pixels</code>	Raw pixels encoded (stride	<code>imagekit.h</code>
<code>ik_scale</code>	The low-level one	<code>imagekit.h</code>
<code>ik_scale_rgb</code>	The same for pixels whose top byte is not an alpha (0x00RRGGBB, a window's canvas, a photo)	<code>imagekit.h</code>
<code>ik_resize</code>	a new picture of that size	<code>imagekit.h</code>
<code>ik_fit</code>	within the box, proportions kept (grow 0: never larger)	<code>imagekit.h</code>
<code>ik_cover</code>	the middle cut to that shape and brought to it (a thumbnail)	<code>imagekit.h</code>
<code>ik_crop</code>	in place -> 0 / -1	<code>imagekit.h</code>
<code>ik_rotate</code>	clockwise, in place	<code>imagekit.h</code>
<code>ik_flip</code>	0: left-right, 1: top-	<code>imagekit.h</code>

Name	What it does	Header
	bottom	
<code>ik_orient</code>	1..8 applied	<code>imagekit.h</code>
<code>ik_straighten</code>	a small angle, enlarged so no corner is empty (the result opaque)	<code>imagekit.h</code>
<code>ik_adjust</code>	(a type)	<code>imagekit.h</code>
<code>ik_adjust_apply</code>	in place (the alpha kept)	<code>imagekit.h</code>
<code>ik_adjust_auto</code>	"enhance": from the picture's histogram	<code>imagekit.h</code>
<code>ik_filter_name</code>	"Black and white" ...	<code>imagekit.h</code>

`imagekit/imagekit.h`

`imagekit.h` -- ImageKit: pictures, one copy for the whole system (SD:/lib/imagekit.so; the shared libraries: docs/03 section 5.6). A program links `lib/imagekit.imp.a` and calls plain C functions (`ik_*`). The first version (2026-10-05) is the base every program that shows or writes a picture needs; the layers, the masks and the brushes of the photo editor come on top of it later.

```

images      a picture in memory (ik_image): w x h pixels 0xAARRGGBB, straight alpha, rows
one
            after the other
  reading    BMP, GIF (animated too), PNG, JPEG, PCX, WebP -- from a file or from memory;
what a
            file says without decoding it (its size, the camera's orientation, date,
model);
            the camera's own preview
  writing     PNG (zlib's compression, through FileKit), JPEG, BMP, GIF -- to a file or to
memory
  transforms ONE resize, right in alpha (the average of what a pixel covers when smaller,
            bilinear when larger); fit, cover, crop, quarter turns, flips, the camera's
            orientation applied, straightened by a small angle
  adjustments exposure, contrast, highlights, shadows, saturation, warmth, sharpness and six
            filters as one tone curve; "enhance" from the histogram (Photos' own)

```

Every call takes integers and pointers only: a program built without the FPU calls it. An `ik_image` is opaque (its format may grow: 16 bits a channel later); a buffer the library returns (`void **out`) is freed with `ik_free`.

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```
void ik_free (void *p);           // a buffer the library returned
```

a picture in memory

```
#define IK_RGB8 1 // 0xAARRGGBB, 8 bits a channel, straight alpha (the only
format today)

typedef struct ik_image ik_image;
ik_image *ik_image_new (int w, int h); // transparent black; 0: no memory, a bad
size
ik_image *ik_image_from (const unsigned *px, int w, int h, int stride); // a copy of pixels
(stride: in pixels)
ik_image *ik_image_copy (const ik_image *im);
void ik_image_free (ik_image *im);
int ik_width (const ik_image *im);
int ik_height (const ik_image *im);
int ik_format (const ik_image *im); // IK_RGB8
unsigned *ik_pixels (ik_image *im); // its w * h pixels (until the image changes
size)
void ik_fill (ik_image *im, unsigned argb);
void ik_opaque (ik_image *im); // every pixel's alpha 255
void ik_flatten (ik_image *im, unsigned rgb); // laid on a colour, the result
opaque
int ik_has_alpha (const ik_image *im); // 1: a pixel is not opaque
```

the formats, asked (version 2)

A program lists what the library reads and writes instead of keeping its own list: a format the library learns is one every program has.

```
struct ik_format
{
    char name[12]; // "PNG", "JPEG", "GIF", "BMP", "PCX", "WebP"
    char extensions[40]; // "jpg jpeg jpe" (lower case, a space between)
    int can_read, can_write;
    int alpha; // it keeps transparency
    int animated; // it may hold several frames (read as ik_frames)
    int reserved[4];
};
int ik_formats (struct ik_format *out, int max); // how many there are (out: up to
max)
```

reading

```
#define IK_ORIENT 1 // the camera's orientation (EXIF) applied: as the photo is
seen

struct ik_info
{
    int w, h; // as stored (before the orientation); 0: not known without
decoding
    int orientation; // 1..8 (EXIF), 1: as stored
    long long taken; // when (seconds, local time, from 1970), 0: not known
    char camera[64]; // "Google Pixel 8" ("": not known)
    char exposure[64]; // "f/1.7 · 1/640 s · ISO 50 · 6.9 mm"
    int has_preview; // the camera's own small picture is in the file
(ik_load_preview)
    int reserved[8];
};
int ik_is_image_name (const char *name); // by its extension (bmp gif png jpg jpeg
jpe pcx webp)
int ik_probe (const char *path, struct ik_info *out); // 1 / 0: not a picture this
```

```

reads
ik_image *ik_load (const char *path, int flags);    // the picture (an animation: its
first frame); 0
ik_image *ik_load_mem (const void *data, unsigned n, int flags);
ik_image *ik_load_preview (const char *path);    // the camera's preview, turned as
seen; 0: none
const char *ik_load_format (void);    // the last picture read: "PNG", "JPEG"...
("": none)

```

An animation (a GIF): every frame.

```

typedef struct ik_frames ik_frames;
ik_frames *ik_frames_load (const char *path);
ik_frames *ik_frames_load_mem (const void *data, unsigned n);
int ik_frames_count (const ik_frames *f);
const unsigned *ik_frames_pixels (const ik_frames *f, int i);    // frame i: w * h pixels (the
library's)
int ik_frames_delay (const ik_frames *f, int i);    // how long it shows, ms (0: a still
picture)
int ik_frames_width (const ik_frames *f);
int ik_frames_height (const ik_frames *f);
void ik_frames_free (ik_frames *f);

```

The frames handed over to the caller (px[i]: new unsigned[w * h], the caller's to delete []; delay[i]: ms): up to max of them -> how many; f keeps none of those. (UIKit's img_load is this.)

```

int ik_frames_take (ik_frames *f, unsigned **px, int *delay, int max);

```

A deflate stream inflated (zlib: with its header, as PNG's; else raw): a new unsigned char[] of *out_n bytes (the caller's to delete []), or 0. (UIKit's img_inflate; a new program takes FileKit's.)

```

unsigned char *ik_inflate (const void *data, unsigned n, int zlib, unsigned *out_n);

```

writing

format: "png", "jpg" / "jpeg", "bmp", "gif" (letters' case ignored). quality: JPEG's 1..100 (0: 90). A picture with transparency keeps it in PNG; GIF keeps its clear pixels (alpha < 128) clear and the others opaque; JPEG and BMP lay it on white.

```

int ik_encode (const ik_image *im, const char *format, int quality, void **out, unsigned
*out_n);    // 0 / -1
int ik_save (const ik_image *im, const char *path, int quality);    // the format from the
path's extension -> 0 / -1

```

Raw pixels encoded (stride: pixels a row). alpha: 1 kept where the format has it (PNG: RGBA), 0 not (PNG: RGB, whatever the top bytes hold), -1 kept when a pixel is not opaque. (img/pngsave.hpp's encoders are this, in the programs built with PNGSAVE_USE_IMAGEKIT.)

```

int ik_encode_pixels (const unsigned *px, int w, int h, int stride, const char *format, int
quality, int alpha,
void **out, unsigned *out_n);

```

transforms

The low-level one: the rectangle (sx, sy, sw, sh) of src (src_w x src_h, src_stride pixels a row) brought to dst (dw x dh, dst_stride pixels a row). Right in alpha (the colours weighed by it). A big shrink reads at most ~8 x 8 of the pixels each result covers (a 24 Mpx photo's thumbnail stays quick).

```
void ik_scale (const unsigned *src, int src_w, int src_h, int src_stride, int sx, int sy, int
sw, int sh,
              unsigned *dst, int dst_stride, int dw, int dh);
```

The same for pixels whose top byte is not an alpha (0x00RRGGBB, a window's canvas, a photo): the colours alone; the result's top byte is 0.

```
void ik_scale_rgb (const unsigned *src, int src_w, int src_h, int src_stride, int sx, int sy,
int sw, int sh,
                  unsigned *dst, int dst_stride, int dw, int dh);
ik_image *ik_resize (const ik_image *im, int w, int h); // a new picture of that size
ik_image *ik_fit (const ik_image *im, int max_w, int max_h, int grow); // within the box,
proportions kept (grow 0: never larger)
ik_image *ik_cover (const ik_image *im, int w, int h); // the middle cut to that shape
and brought to it (a thumbnail)
int ik_crop (ik_image *im, int x, int y, int w, int h); // in place -> 0 / -1
int ik_rotate (ik_image *im, int quarter_turns); // clockwise, in place
int ik_flip (ik_image *im, int vertical); // 0: left-right, 1: top-bottom
int ik_orient (ik_image *im, int exif_orientation); // 1..8 applied
int ik_straighten (ik_image *im, int millidegrees); // a small angle, enlarged so no
corner is empty (the result opaque)
```

adjustments (Photos')

```
#define IK_FILTER_NONE      0
#define IK_FILTER_BW        1
#define IK_FILTER_WARM      2
#define IK_FILTER_COOL      3
#define IK_FILTER_VINTAGE    4
#define IK_FILTER_VIVID     5
#define IK_FILTERS          6
```

```
struct ik_adjust
{
    int exposure, contrast, highlights, shadows, saturation, warmth; // -100..100, 0: as
it is
    int sharpness; // 0..100
    int filter; // IK_FILTER_*
    int reserved[8]; // 0
};
void ik_adjust_apply (ik_image *im, const struct ik_adjust *a); // in place (the alpha kept)
void ik_adjust_auto (const ik_image *im, struct ik_adjust *out); // "enhance": from the
picture's histogram
const char *ik_filter_name (int filter); // "Black and white" ...
}
#endif
```